10. The Levant is an approximate historical geographical term referring to a large area in the Eastern Mediterranean region of Western Asia. In its narrowest sense, it is equivalent to the historical region of Syria, which included present-day Syria, Lebanon, Jordan, Israel and Palestine. In its widest historical sense, the Levant included all of the Eastern Mediterranean with its islands, that is, it included all of the countries along the Eastern Mediterranean shores, extending from Greece to Cyrenaica in eastern Libya.
11. Chernozem ("black soil") is a black-coloured soil containing a high percentage of humus (4 to 16%) and high percentages of phosphoric acids, phosphorus and ammonia. Chernozem is very fertile and can produce high agricultural yields with its high moisture storage capacity. Chernozems are also a Reference Soil Group of the World Reference Base for Soil Resources (WRB).
12. Statement 1: INCORRECT—Alluvial soils cover the river valleys of the Tigris-Euphrates, the plains of Indus-Ganga Rivers, the lower Irrawaddy basin, the deltas of the Mekong and the lower basins of Chang Jiang, Huanghe Rivers, as well as the river plains of smaller rivers in India, Malaysia, the Philippines, Taiwan, Korea, and Japan.
    Statement 2: CORRECT—Several islands of Indonesia and southern Philippines contain active volcanoes that periodically provide a new layer of rich basic soils of recently deposited volcanic materials
13. Tropical and subtropical soils are generally immature and unproductive. The soils of the middle latitudes are themselves suitable, but lack of water is often a key factor. Only the alluvial soils of the river plains and the basic soils produced by the volcanic ejecta are productive soils.